PAHADI KHATKI

"Thodi Khatti, Thodi Teekhi, Poori Pahadi"

Operations & Growth Playbook: Packaging SOP, Micro-Batch Economics & Retention Engine

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1. Complete Packaging & Dispatch Equipment Checklist (Jar to Doorstep)

For artisanal non-veg pickles, packaging is the single most critical touchpoint. Below is the complete procurement checklist across all 4 levels:

Category	Item Name & Exact Specification	Critical Purpose	Market Rate
Bottling	250ml Glass Lug Jar (63mm Neck)	Food-safe soda lime glass. Zero acid/oil reaction. Wide mouth allows spoons easily.	**₹18.00 / pc**
Bottling	63mm Metal Lug Cap with Plastisol Liner	Plastisol ring forms an airtight hermetic seal under torque.	**Included with jar**
Bottling	63mm Pressure Sensitive Foam Wad	Placed inside cap. Bonds to glass rim under pressure, stops oil seepage.	**₹2.00 / pc**
Bottling	63mm PVC Heat Shrink Band	Shrunk via hair dryer in 3 seconds. Tamper-evident lock against transit vibration.	**₹1.50 / pc**
Branding	Waterproof Matte Vinyl Labels (Front+Back)	100% oil & waterproof. Front: Brand+250g. Back: FSSAI No, Ingredients, Nutrition.	**₹6.00 / jar**
Branding	Top Cap Round Logo Sticker (50mm)	Round vinyl sticker on metal cap for premium unboxing presentation.	**₹1.50 / pc**
Safety	Inflatable Air Column Sleeve (Bottle Protector)	Surrounds jar in 360° air cushion. Far superior to crumbly thermocol.	**₹6.00 / pc**
Safety	3-Ply Hard Corrugated Box (5x5x6 inch / 13x13x15 cm)	Snug fit for 250g jar + air sleeve. Exactly fits Shiprocket 0.5kg volumetric slab.	**₹8.00 / pc**
Dispatch	Fragile Tape, Kraft Tape & Courier Barcode Label	Clear warning for handlers and barcode protection against rain/spills.	**₹2.00 / pc**
Hardware	Digital Kitchen Scale + Hair Dryer (1000W)	Exact 250g food measurement & instant heat-shrinking of PVC bands.	**One-time ~₹1,200**

Volumetric Weight Rule (Why 5 x 5 x 6 inch is Mandatory for 250g Jar)

Courier companies charge by the higher of Actual Weight vs Volumetric Weight: (L × W × H in cm) / 5000.

- 5 x 5 x 6 inch (13 x 13 x 15 cm) box = (13 × 13 × 15) / 5000 = 0.507 kg (~0.5 kg slab). Fits perfectly at ₹80 shipping!
- 6 x 6 x 7 inch box = (15 × 15 × 18) / 5000 = 0.81 kg. Courier will charge for 1.0 kg (₹130). Always use 5x5x6 inch for single 250g jars.

2. Micro-Level 1 kg & 5 kg Chicken Pickle Batch Economics

Calculated on fresh boneless chicken at ₹300/kg. 1 kg raw boneless meat shrinks to ~600g after frying. Adding 450g of mustard oil, spices, and vinegar yields ~1,050g of finished pickle, perfectly filling 4 jars of 250g net weight.

Expense Component	Quantity / Specification	Per 1 kg Batch (4 Jars)	Per 1 Jar (250g)
Fresh Boneless Chicken Breast	1,000 g raw meat (at ₹300/kg)	₹300.00	₹75.00
Pure Kachi Ghani Mustard Oil	300 ml cold-pressed mustard oil	₹45.00	₹11.25
Ginger & Garlic Paste	80 g fresh peeled paste	₹10.00	₹2.50
Pahadi Khada Whole Spices	40 g jeera, methi, saunf, rai, etc.	₹18.00	₹4.50
Ground Kashmiri Spices & Rock Salt	30 g haldi, lal mirch, sendha namak	₹12.00	₹3.00
Synthetic White Vinegar & Gas Fuel	50 ml vinegar + 1 hr LPG cooking	₹18.00	₹4.50
Subtotal: Raw Edible Food Cost	**~1,050g finished pickle yield**	**₹403.00 (~₹410)**	**₹102.50 (~₹105)**
Glass Jar + Metal Cap + Foam Wad	250ml glass jar + 63mm lug cap + seal	₹80.00	₹20.00
Labels + PVC Shrink Band	Waterproof front/back + cap band	₹30.00	₹7.50
Air Column Bag + 3-Ply Box + Tape	Inflatable sleeve + 5x5x6 box + tape	₹56.00	₹14.00
Subtotal: Packaging Materials	**Complete 4-layer safe protocol**	**₹166.00**	**₹41.50**
Pan-India Courier (Shiprocket)	0.5 kg slab doorstep pickup	₹320.00	₹80.00
Payment Gateway Processing	Razorpay 2% of ₹399 customer price	₹32.00	₹8.00
TOTAL DELIVERED COST	**Food + Packaging + Shipping + Gateway**	**₹928.00 (~₹938)**	**₹234.50**

5 kg Production Batch Economics (50/50 Equal Profit Split)

When Himachal kitchen executes a 5 kg boneless chicken batch:

- Finished Output: 20 Jars (250g each)
- Total Customer Revenue: 20 jars × ₹399.00 = ₹7,980.00
- Total Landed Costs (Food + Packing + Courier + Gateway): 20 × ₹234.50 = ₹4,690.00
- Net Clean Profit Generated: ₹3,290.00 (~₹3,300 to ₹3,500)

50/50 Profit Distribution:

- Himachal Partner Share: ₹1,650.00 – ₹1,750.00 per 5kg batch
- Chennai (Arun) Share: ₹1,650.00 – ₹1,750.00 per 5kg batch

Scale Milestones:

- 1 Batch / week (80 jars/mo) = ₹13,200 Net Profit (₹6,600 each)
- 3 Batches / week (240 jars/mo) = ₹39,600 Net Profit (₹19,800 each)
- Daily 10 Jars (300 jars/mo) = ₹49,350 Net Profit (₹24,675 each side-income)

3. The 5-Pillar Customer Retention & Repeat Order Playbook

In D2C artisanal food, acquisition cost is recovered on the first purchase, but real wealth is built through habitual repeat orders. A 250g jar consumed by 1–2 persons lasts 15–20 days. Below is the systematic framework to ensure customers reorder automatically:

- **Pillar 1: The Golden Unboxing Card (Immediate Discount Anchor):** Never ship an empty box. Resting on top of the air sleeve, place a high-gsm printed card: 'Pahadon se aapke plate tak! Loved the mountain heat? Use code PAHADI15 for Flat 15% OFF on your next jar at pahadikhatki.in or WhatsApp 98XXXXXXXX.' Plant the economic incentive on Day 1.
- **Pillar 2: Day-18 Automated WhatsApp Reorder Trigger:** Using webhooks tied to Shiprocket delivery dates, send an automated WhatsApp message exactly on Day 18 (when only 2–3 spoonfuls remain): 'Hey [Name]! Your jar of Pahadi Khatki Chicken Pickle is probably down to its last bite. Our fresh batch is slow-cooking on the chulha right now. Tap to reorder in 1-click (VIP 15% discount pre-applied): [Link]'. Intercept them at the moment of depletion.
- **Pillar 3: Limited Batch & Freshness Scarcity Hype:** Leverage small-batch authenticity over mass factory scale. Post regular kitchen updates on WhatsApp and Instagram: 'Batch #06 bottled this morning — only 40 jars available. 24 already pre-booked!' Creates natural FOMO and prompts customers to reserve before running out.
- **Pillar 4: SKU Cross-Pollination (Expanding the Palate):** When a chicken pickle customer expresses satisfaction, introduce variety: 'Loved the teekha chicken? Our Pahadi Mutton Pickle is slow-cooked for 3 hours with whole Kashmiri spices. Try a 250g Mutton jar next!' Or suggest the Himalayan Trout Fish Pickle for seafood lovers.
- **Pillar 5: Consistent Flavor Craving (The Habit Loop):** Cravings stem from predictable, unmatched taste. Maintain a strict 60% boneless meat and 40% pungent mustard oil/masala ratio. Ensure pieces remain juicy and chewable, never dry or hard. The raw mustard oil heat + mild vinegar tang turns ordinary meals addictive.